FROM MOTHER RACHEL

Can you believe it? Five years have flown past since we reopened our doors at the end of the COVID pandemic. It has been a privilege to be part of this season of renewal at Grace Mission. Despite the challenges of our tiny operation (one full-time and four part-time staff) responding to the ever increasing needs around us, we have witnessed God at work and his abundant provision. We are so thankful for all our faithful donors and volunteers who have helped us get back on our feet and keep moving forwards.

God has been moving powerfully. It's like watching a spring of life-giving water bubbling up and pouring out. We have seen miracles of healing, people arising from places of despair to renewed hope, families being reconciled, compassion softening hearts throughout the wider community, and new partners forged to effect real change. As 2026 draws to a close, we are counting our blessings for the fruit that has been borne, the new doors that have opened, and the joy of being part of this mission.

We are so thankful for each one of you! Whatever you have done to care for those in need has not gone unnoticed! May God bless you richly!

Mother Rachel

BLESSING 1:

Strengthened Christian Community:

It is a great blessing to be part of the Grace Mission church family! Together, we worship on Sunday afternoons, meditate on God's word during weekday Bible study, pray for one another during the week, and live out our faith by loving God and our neighbor. Many of the people in our community are deeply faithful, whilst others are seeking to connect or reconnect with God. We pray often for the greater Tallahassee community.

> *"Every time you pray for me, something good always happens in response."*

PHOTO TO COME
Worship or Bible study

A Message from Board Member Jonathan Jackson

Serving on the Advisory Board of Grace Mission is one way I live out my Christian faith. I believe we are called to love our neighbors actively through service, compassion, and generosity. Every week, I am amazed by what God is doing through this ministry—in the faithful support of our donors, the generous hearts of our volunteers, the dedication of our staff, and, most importantly, in the lives and souls of the people we walk with.

Recently, the Grace Mission staff, board members, volunteers, and those we serve met for a time of discernment. Through the precious gift of our loving community, we recognized what the Lord is already doing among us. We also identified obstacles to growth and steps to overcome them. We are looking for staff, board and team members who can contribute their time and talents, as we move into the next phase of growth and ministry.

Grace Mission continues to grow and move forward, reminding us that God's work is never finished. New opportunities, new challenges, and new beginnings are all part of the journey. What inspires me most is that God works through "ordinary" people who answer the call to serve, often in extraordinary ways. I am grateful to be a small part of this ministry, and I look forward with faith and excitement to all that God has yet to do at Grace Mission!

Are you a friend of Grace? Tell Us Your Story.

Can you believe it's been almost 30 years of Grace? Easter Day 2027 marks our 30th anniversary. We are collecting stories from past and present volunteers and supporters about how you saw God move at Grace. Tributes about our faith community are also welcome. We will share these stories in our newsletter in the coming months.

Ready to Volunteer?

Come see for yourself how God is working through Grace Mission. We need volunteers for regularly programmed events as well as for special projects planned in celebration of Grace Mission's 30th Anniversary in 2027.

To learn more, email volunteer@gracemission.net

Get Ready to Celebrate! Grace Mission is Turning 30!

Looking ahead to the next thirty years at Grace Mission, we need your help! If you are interested in getting involved with Grace Mission's anniversary celebrations, email donormanager@gracemission.net to learn more.

2026

Annual Praise Report

PHOTO TO COME
Grace Mission community

TALLAHASSEE, FLORIDA

BLESSING 2:

Behind the Scenes Support :

We are thankful for our generous donors who recognise that our staff is overstretched and stepped up with funding for three new positions for the year ahead. We are presently looking for a staff and volunteer administrator, an office administrator, and a finance administrator. Praise God for his perfect provision in these new team members who will alleviate much of the stress our staff has experienced in trying to meet the growing needs of our community.

BLESSING 3:

Improved Medical Care for Our Unhoused Neighbors

We are excited to announce our partnership with the North Florida Street Medicine Collaborative, a coalition of the city's key players working to meet the medical needs of our unhoused neighbors and reduce the costly overuse of EMS and ER services.

Funded by a grant awarded to Tallahassee Memorial Hospital Family Practice, the Collaborative will train all of TMH's resident doctors in caring for people living without shelter. With the support of the FSU College of Medicine, we have launched a weekly clinic at Grace Mission. providing free services to those in need!

"Grace Mission is a beacon of hope for the homeless community."

BLESSING 4:

Jobs and Support for Our Neighbors Finding Work

We recently participated in a"Better Together" job fair, held at Jacob's Chapel. With the support of First Presbyterian Church, we prepared resumes for more than 30 people and supplied showers, haircuts, interview outfits, transportation and a lot of encouragement. Almost half found jobs!

Our Angel Tree supporters provided #s of steel toed workboots, nonslip restaurant shoes throughout the year, along with bus passes for new employees until their first pay check.

"We have much to be thankful for!

100 housed.

250 medication copays.

142 IDs.

28 employed.

420 showers and laundry.

>2 tons of clothing distributed."

BLESSING 5:

Affordable Housing Resources and Financial Support

Grace Mission's social workers work tirelessly to help people secure affordable housing, then support them as they adjust to life off the streets. This year alone, we also supported 160 people who could not otherwise afford the shelter's $150.00-per-week fee*. (*For locals who have stayed more than 90 days, or more than 3 days for people from out of the area.)

BLESSING 6:

A Growing Team of Social Workers

Lovena, our first fulltime social worker, has formed meaningful relationships with and helped many of our neighbors through crises. She is assisted by a part-time social worker who recently joined our staff as well as a steady flow of social worker interns eager to develop the skills and experience needed to work in such a challenging but supportive environment. We are also laying the groundwork for creating a team of voluntary social workers to help manage our work load.

"Whenever I drive by Grace, I feel a wave of love emanating from that place."

BLESSING 7:

Volunteers We Can Count On

This year, the number of college students volunteering at Grace has increased substantially. Everyday, up to five FAMU students from the Criminal Justice department along with FSU students from various programs and organizations on campus are on hand to help with whatever is needed and grow in compassion.

Additionally, our volunteers come from senior living facilities, Bible study groups, local schools, youth groups, and confirmation classes to serve our neighbors. Grace Mission would not exist without our volunteers, and we are so grateful for you all!

PHOTO TO COME
Social work team

PHOTO TO COME
Volunteers in action

BLESSING 8:

Continued Donations from Our Generous Community

Longtime supporter Lou Armesto has stepped in as our new Development Administrator to help Grace stay connected with long term and brand new donors. We hope you notice a difference! She is always happy to schedule a tour or help you with your donations.

Financial and in-kind donations have been perfectly timed. However, because the need is always there, we are continually accepting donations of money, clothing, hygiene items, new home starter kits, and weekly PB&Js. We have also received new-to-us chairs for the chapel and turkeys for Thanksgiving dinner—donated by one church and cooked by another! We even received a generous gift from a man living in poverty who received a long-awaited settlement. Such generous and loving outpouring reveals the hearts of our donors and their compassion and care for those in need!

BLESSING 9:

Nutritious Meals for the Hungry

Our food budget for 2026 is only $150.00 a week to provide an average of 500-600 nutritious meals plus bagged lunches, snack bags, fruit, and ice water. Every week we witness the miraculous multiplication of our resources thanks to partners such as Second Harvest, Register's Meat Company, Dollar General, Chicken Salad Chick, Four Rivers, and Publix who recycle their food resources and keep us cooking!

Our small but mighty food pantry is also routinely replenished by local churches and individuals. This past summer alone, St. John's VBS donated one-and-a-half tons of food they had collected. When Grace Mission closes for two weeks in the summer and after Christmas, a team of churches that are members of the Capital Area Justice Ministry (CAJM) step forward to ensure that our neighbors continue to receive care while our staff takes a well deserved break. We are thankful for their love in action!

"I only eat five meals a week, all of them at Grace Mission."

BLESSING 10:

Building Community Through Music

The band is back together! In partnership with the FSU College of Music, the resurrected Shelter Band practices every Tuesday afternoon at Grace Mission, playing rock and folk music chosen by participants. We also have formed the Grace Mission Choir, creating a space for our community to enjoy the warmth, interaction, and joy of singing together.

This year our worship team has grown to include members from our Grace community. Mr. Emory plays a mean harmonica joined by Mr. Isaiah on the bongos and Mr. David on the drums. Others join on Sundays to make a joyful noise and beautiful praise. The music ranges from traditional hymns, gospel, and contemporary praise songs to spirituals and camp-style choruses. Praising God through singing and playing music lifts our hearts to the Lord while also encouraging and caring for each other.